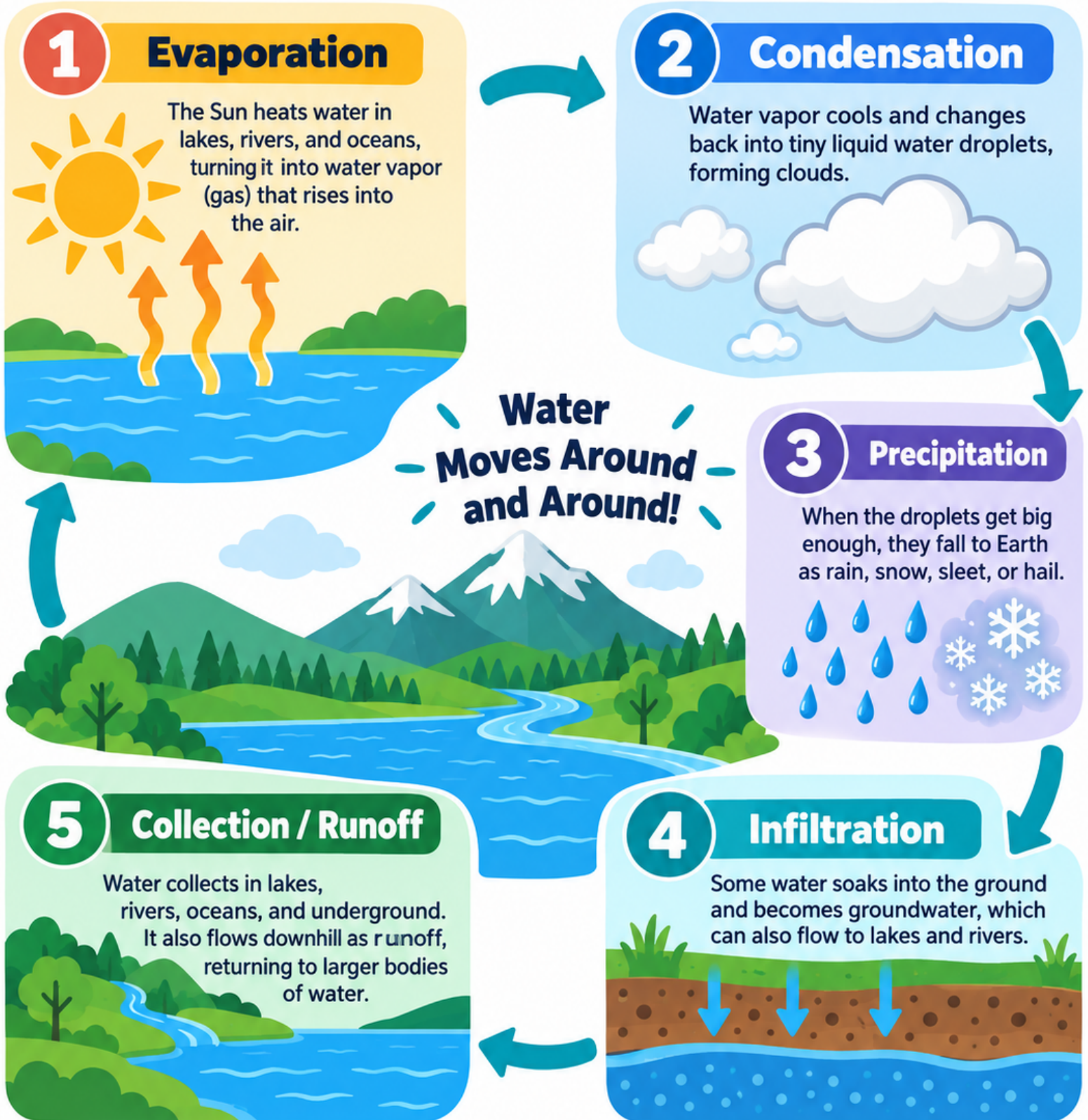


The Water Cycle

Powered by the Sun



The Sun's energy keeps water moving through the cycle again and again.

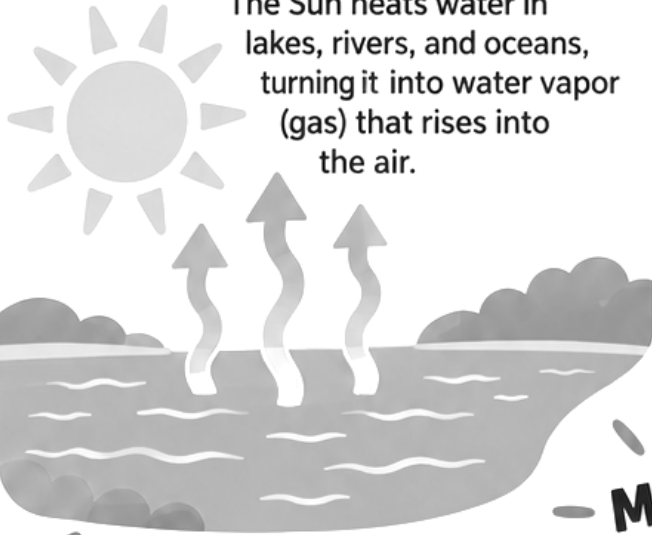
The Water Cycle

Powered by the Sun

1

Evaporation

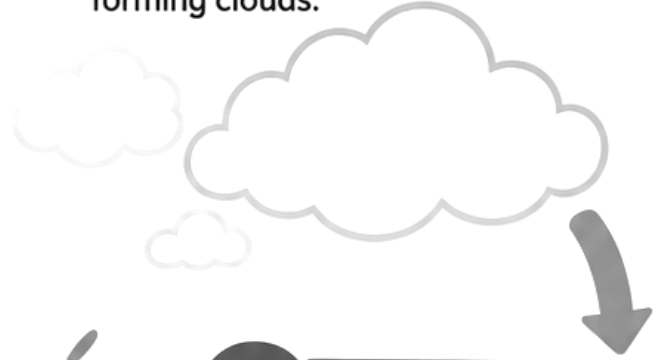
The Sun heats water in lakes, rivers, and oceans, turning it into water vapor (gas) that rises into the air.



2

Condensation

Water vapor cools and changes back into tiny liquid water droplets, forming clouds.



3

Precipitation

When the droplets get big enough, they fall to Earth as rain, snow, sleet, or hail.



5

Collection / Runoff

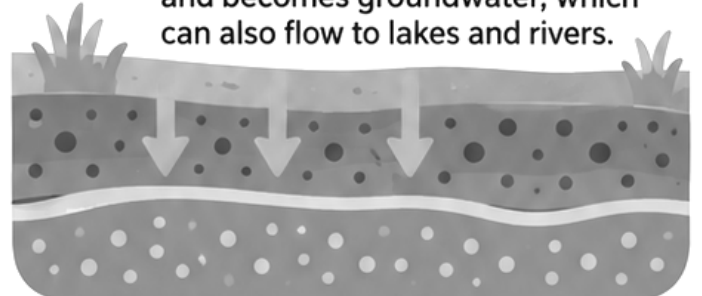
Water collects in lakes, rivers, oceans, and underground. It also flows downhill as runoff, returning to larger bodies of water.



4

Infiltration

Some water soaks into the ground and becomes groundwater, which can also flow to lakes and rivers.



Water
Moves Around
and Around!



The Sun's energy keeps water moving through the cycle again and again.